

UNDERSTANDING YOURSELF

We are all individuals with our own personality, interests, skills, and values. To find a good career match, you first need to think about yourself—not only about what interests you, but your skills, personal qualities, motivators, and character. This reflection will help you plan future training and work experience, strengthen your résumé, and make informed career decisions.



WHAT SUBJECTS DO YOU LIKE?

Which subjects do you enjoy at school? Which are you best at? How can you improve your performance in the subjects you like the most?



WHAT OTHER INTERESTS DO YOU HAVE?

Do you play sports? Employers and colleges look for a range of interests beyond schoolwork. Taking part, and succeeding in, activities such as sports demonstrates your ability to work well with others—an important part of many jobs.

Lots of people have hobbies that develop into careers, and not always in obvious ways. If you enjoy drama, for example, you might go on to forge a career as an actor, but you also have skills that could be used when giving marketing or business presentations, or working as a teacher.

Think about your hobbies and interests and how they could be put to use in the workplace.



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WHAT MOTIVATES YOU?

What is most important in your life? Do you want fame, status, and high earnings, or would you gain more satisfaction from helping others in the community? Do you seek excitement and challenge in your life, or are stability, freedom, and comfort more valuable?